

SALMAN MUSHTAQ

Lead Software Engineer | Backend & Platform Architecture | Python, Go, AWS

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Transferable Iqama | Notice Period: 30 Days

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead backend engineer and Software Development Manager with 10+ years building production platforms in Saudi Arabia. Hands-on architect of a social app with 200K users (~20K daily active), a palm-biometric payments ecosystem (Moyasar, card tokenization) and a multi-tenant OAuth2 identity platform using Python/FastAPI, Go, PostgreSQL, AWS and GCP. Cut API latency by up to 60% and CI/CD time by 83%, and lead a 16-member cross-functional team. Previously lead developer for Saudi Electricity Company smart metering across 15,000 meters.

CORE SKILLS

Backend: Python, FastAPI, SQLAlchemy, Alembic, AsyncIO, Go, REST APIs, Microservices, Modular Monolith, Event-Driven Architecture, System Design, OAuth2, JWT, Redis

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Amazon Aurora, Query Optimization, Execution Plans, Indexing, Partitioning

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EKS, Lambda, SQS, SNS, EventBridge, S3, RDS/Aurora, CloudFront), GCP (GKE), Multi-Cloud Architecture, Kubernetes, Cloudflare, CI/CD, Trunk-Based Development, Feature Flags

Observability: OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, Sentry, New Relic, Custom Metrics

Payments & Integrations: Moyasar Payment Gateway, Card Tokenization, Biometric Identity, Multi-Tenant SaaS, FCM, Unifonic, Infobip (SMS/WhatsApp)

Leadership & Delivery: Engineering Management, Team Leadership, Technical Hiring, Agile/Scrum, Jira, Sprint Planning, Backlog Prioritization, PRDs, Stakeholder Management, Cross-Functional Delivery, Code Review

Industrial / IoT: Smart Metering, DLMS, Modbus, SCADA, Zero Trust

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

LINK SOCIAL NETWORK - Riyadh, Saudi Arabia | Apr 2023 - Present

Early-stage company building social, digital-identity, palm-biometric and payment products. Joined as the first backend engineer; promoted to Software Development Manager in under two years.

Software Development Manager | Mar 2025 - Present

- Remain the hands-on backend owner: write core microservices, review and approve all backend pull requests, and continuously evolve system architecture with the CTO.
- **Link Identity:** Architected a centralized, multi-tenant identity platform with OAuth2, deployable on cloud or on-premise, serving as the shared backbone for Link Wallet and Link Palm.
- **Link Wallet:** Led backend for a digital wallet that links payment cards to a user's palm; integrated the Moyasar payment gateway with card tokenization so stored tokens authorize palm-based payments.
- **Link Palm:** Led SDK development for palm registration and payment hardware, coordinating internal engineers and an external hardware partner.
- Lead a 16-member cross-functional team across Backend, iOS, Android, QA and UI/UX, including two mobile team leads; personally hired 10 of the 16.
- Own delivery of the Link Social app (200K users, ~20K daily active users) on the Apple App Store and Google Play; translate CEO and VP business goals into PRDs and a prioritized Jira backlog, and run Scrum ceremonies including sprint planning and planning poker.
- Partner with Cybersecurity, DevOps and SRE teams on security best practices, infrastructure and releases; supported a palm-payment Proof of Concept with Saudi Awwal Bank (SAB).

Senior Software Engineer - Backend Lead | Apr 2023 - Mar 2025

- Joined as the first backend engineer and grew the backend team to 8 (4 full-time engineers and 4 freelance contractors); led architecture, code reviews, standards and technical decisions from Dec 2023.
- Designed the initial cloud-based microservices architecture; built core services for posts, reactions, comments and notifications using Python, FastAPI, SQLAlchemy, Alembic and PostgreSQL.
- Shipped the first production release on the App Store and Google Play in Sep 2023 and scaled the platform to 200K users.
- Reduced API response times from ~800 ms to ~400 ms (50%) and SLA-critical APIs from ~500 ms to ~200 ms (60%) through PostgreSQL execution-plan analysis, indexing and application-logic optimization.

- Cut the end-to-end CI/CD pipeline from ~2 hours to ~20 minutes (83%) while keeping build, QA, security-scan, test and deployment stages.
- Moved the team from multi-branch GitHub Flow to trunk-based development with feature flags across three deployment environments.
- Moved synchronous workloads to event-driven processing using AWS SQS, SNS, Lambda and EventBridge; consolidated selected microservices into a modular monolith where independent deployment did not justify the operational cost.
- Integrated FCM push notifications, Unifonic SMS and WhatsApp messaging via Infobip; introduced Agile/Scrum and helped establish a dedicated QA function.

MEMF IDEAL TECHNICAL SOLUTIONS - Saudi Arabia | Nov 2016 - Apr 2023

Senior Software Developer (Nov 2021 - Apr 2023) | Software Developer (Nov 2016 - Nov 2021)

- Lead developer for smart-metering software on a ~SAR 15M Saudi Electricity Company (SEC) project, enabling remote reading of 15,000 electricity meters across the Kingdom via DLMS and Modbus.
- Developed the SMARTEX multi-utility platform covering electricity, gas, water and building-management systems.
- Delivered technical implementation for Saudi Aramco SAOO and NAOO industrial-cybersecurity Proofs of Concept using Xage Security Zero Trust technology.
- Built billing-system capabilities for ACWA Power's Sakaka Solar PV project with partner Enexsa.
- Built internal HR, Finance and approval-workflow applications in C# and PHP, replacing paper-based processes company-wide.

2B VISION TECHNOLOGIES - Lahore, Pakistan | Dec 2015 - Jul 2016

C# Developer

- Built and maintained client business applications using C# and ASP.NET MVC.

EDUCATION

- **MSc in Information Technology** - PUCIT, University of the Punjab, Lahore | Oct 2014
- **BSc in Advanced Computer Studies** - The Islamia University of Bahawalpur | Aug 2012

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Generative AI Developer - Professional (in progress)
- PMP - exam in progress (35 contact hours completed, Simplilearn, 2026)
- Software Engineer; REST API (Intermediate) - HackerRank, 2023
- Certified WebAccess/SCADA Application Engineer - Advantech, 2017

COMMUNITY

Technical writer since 2012 (C# Corner, codewithsmushtaq.blogspot.com); mentored 100+ students and early-career developers.

LANGUAGES

English (Professional) | Urdu (Native) | Punjabi (Fluent) | Arabic (Basic)